



## Vendor Coordination - Vendor Files

### Policy:

#### State Office

The State WIC Benefit Delivery Unit (BDU) will maintain originals or images (e.g., via paper copies and/or tracking databases, and/or electronically) of:

- *Vendor Agreements, Applications*, details of contacts made with the store, correspondence, *Pre-authorization, and Retailer Routine Monitoring Reports*, training information, etc. for each Vendor.
- Participant Access determinations.

#### Local Agency

LARC shall set up a process that staff members can record comments related to a vendor and/or relay information to the LARC.

**Regulation:** 7 CFR 246.12

### Procedure/Additional Guidance:

- Any vendor information that individually identifies the vendor, except WIC authorization status, store name, store address, telephone number, website, e-mail address, and store description (e.g., chain, grocery, pharmacy) must be restricted to persons directly connected with the administration or enforcement of the Program to maintain vendor confidentiality.
- When forwarding copies of materials to the BDU, scan documents and send them electronically if possible.
  - o Include the proper contact person for a formula ordering problem, a shopping problem, or other issues.
  - o Keep this information available so that patterns may be easily identified. Set up a system to send the information to a central location and/or LARC.
  - o Encourage participants to relay what happens in stores. Having a detailed account with dates and circumstances all documented in a logical order and presented to store personnel is very effective. (REMEMBER: Do not report the participant name/information to a vendor.)
- Keeping detailed, precise records is a key to effective coordination between the State, Local Agency, and vendor. Enter significant communications and events (e.g., visits, issues, resolution, etc.) into the Compass Vendor Log.